

# Critical Thinking & Problem-Solving

## For IT Freshers / New Hires

Assessment Duration: 45–60 Minutes

### SECTION 1 — CRITICAL THINKING

#### 1. Requirement Clarity

A client says:

“The application is slow during peak hours.”

What should the developer do FIRST?

- A. Rewrite the application
- B. Increase server memory immediately
- C. Gather performance logs and identify bottlenecks
- D. Escalate to management

#### 2. Assumption Testing

A team assumes users are unhappy because of UI colors. However, user complaints mainly mention login delays.

What is the best conclusion?

- A. UI colors are the main issue
- B. Technical performance may be impacting user experience more
- C. Users dislike the product completely
- D. Marketing caused the issue

#### 3. Logical Evaluation

All cloud engineers know Linux. Some developers know Linux.

Which statement is definitely true?

- A. All developers are cloud engineers
- B. Some cloud engineers are developers
- C. Cloud engineers know Linux
- D. Linux experts are developers

#### 4. Prioritization Thinking

A production issue affects 10,000 users, while a UI bug affects only 5 users.

What should be prioritized?

A. UI bug

B. Production issue

C. Both equally

D. Wait for manager approval

## 5. Critical Evaluation

A manager says:

“The deployment failed because the developers are inexperienced.”

Which response reflects critical thinking?

A. Agree immediately

B. Blame the developers

C. Investigate logs, deployment process, and environment issues before concluding

D. Escalate HR concerns

## SECTION 2 — PROBLEM-SOLVING SKILLS

### 6. Debugging Scenario

An application crashes only after users upload large files.

What is the MOST likely first area to investigate?

A. UI font size

B. File size handling and memory usage

C. Internet branding strategy

D. Employee attendance

### 7. Time Management Problem

A fresher is assigned 3 urgent tasks with the same deadline.

What should they do FIRST?

A. Panic and multitask randomly

B. Ignore one task

C. Clarify priorities with the lead and estimate effort

D. Work only on the easiest task

## 8. Incident Resolution

A payment API suddenly stops responding.

What is the BEST first step?

- A. Restart all systems immediately
- B. Check API logs, server status, and recent deployments
- C. Inform customers the system is permanently down
- D. Delete old database entries

## 9. Process Improvement

A testing team repeatedly finds the same defects late in the cycle.

What is the BEST improvement approach?

- A. Increase blame discussions
- B. Add earlier automated testing and peer reviews
- C. Skip testing
- D. Reduce documentation

## 10. Resource Optimization

A report generation process takes 4 hours daily.

What is the BEST solution mindset?

- A. Ignore the issue
- B. Analyze automation or optimization opportunities
- C. Add more manual work
- D. Reduce reporting quality

## SECTION 3 — ANALYTICAL DECISION-MAKING

### 11. Data Interpretation

A website traffic report shows:

| Week   | Visitors |
|--------|----------|
| Week 1 | 20,000   |
| Week 2 | 18,000   |
| Week 3 | 10,000   |

What should the analyst do FIRST?

- A. Shut down the website
- B. Investigate possible outages or campaign changes
- C. Ignore the trend
- D. Blame developers immediately

## 12. Risk Analysis

A team wants to deploy directly to production without testing.

What is the biggest risk?

- A. Faster delivery
- B. Reduced documentation
- C. Production failures impacting users
- D. Better innovation

## 13. Decision Making

A client requests a new feature one day before release.

What is the BEST approach?

- A. Add it immediately without analysis
- B. Evaluate impact on timeline, testing, and stability
- C. Reject all requests permanently
- D. Delay release indefinitely

## 14. Pattern Recognition

Server CPU spikes happen every day at exactly 9 PM.

What is the MOST logical inference?

A. Random issue

B. Possible scheduled batch job or backup process

C. Hardware theft

D. Employee login issue

## 15. Strategic Thinking

A support team receives repeated password reset requests.

What is the BEST long-term solution?

A. Hire more support staff

B. Build self-service password reset functionality

C. Ignore requests

D. Reduce security

## SECTION 4 — IT WORKPLACE SCENARIOS

### 16. Client Communication

A client is frustrated during a meeting.

What should the fresher do?

A. Interrupt aggressively

B. Listen carefully, acknowledge concerns, and respond professionally

C. Disconnect from the meeting

D. Blame another team

### 17. Collaboration

A teammate is blocked because of missing information from you.

What demonstrates ownership?

A. Ignore the message

B. Delay response

C. Share the information promptly and help unblock progress

D. Escalate unnecessarily

### 18. Adaptability

A project suddenly changes technology stacks.

What is the BEST response?

- A. Refuse to learn
- B. Complain continuously
- C. Learn the new technology and seek guidance
- D. Quit the project immediately

## 19. Ethical Thinking

You discover incorrect data in a project report.

What should you do?

- A. Hide the issue
- B. Correct and report it transparently
- C. Ignore it
- D. Blame another person

## 20. Innovation Mindset

A repetitive manual task consumes 2 hours daily.

What reflects problem-solving thinking?

- A. Continue manually forever
- B. Explore scripts or automation opportunities
- C. Avoid responsibility
- D. Escalate without analysis

## SECTION 5 — ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

### 21. 5 Why Analysis

A deployment failed because configuration files were missing.

What should be investigated?

- A. Why configuration validation failed before deployment
- B. Office seating arrangements
- C. Employee cafeteria timings
- D. Client logo design

## 22. Troubleshooting Logic

Users cannot access an internal portal.

What should be checked FIRST?

- A. Internet memes
- B. Network connectivity and server availability
- C. Employee birthdays
- D. Marketing campaigns

## **23. Escalation Judgment**

When should a fresher escalate an issue?

- A. Immediately for every small issue
- B. After attempting basic troubleshooting and impact assessment
- C. Never escalate
- D. Only after project completion

## **24. Continuous Improvement**

A sprint missed deadlines because tasks were underestimated.

What is the BEST improvement step?

- A. Stop sprint planning
- B. Improve estimation techniques and retrospective analysis
- C. Ignore deadlines
- D. Reduce communication

## **25. Systems Thinking**

An app performs well individually, but slows when multiple services connect.

What is the likely focus area?

- A. Integration and system dependency analysis
- B. Office furniture
- C. Social media trends
- D. Team outing plans